// ENTERPRISE SOFTWARE IS SHIFTING FROM SYSTEMS OF RECORD TO SYSTEMS OF ACTION

THE 2026 MARKET EVOLUTION OF AGENTIC AI IN ENTERPRISE SAAS

> *2026 is the year agentic AI moves from experimental copilots into embedded enterprise execution.*

ENTERPRISE APPS WITH AGENTS BY END-2026

40%

ENTERPRISE APPS WITH AGENTS IN 2025

<5%

// STRATEGIC_TRANSFORMATION

PROBLEM: TRADITIONAL SAAS STOPS AT ASSISTANCE, NOT EXECUTION

> *Copilots help users work; agents can complete the work*

ORGANIZATIONS ALREADY USING AI IN AT LEAST ONE FUNCTION

About 80%

ORGANIZATIONS REGULARLY USING GENAI

About 70%

STRATEGIC_EXECUTION_MATRIX

01 Legacy SaaS is optimized for human-operated workflows and seat-based usage.

02 GenAI copilots improved search, summarization, and drafting, but not end-to-end execution.

03 Enterprises now want AI that can plan, call tools, trigger workflows, and return completed outcomes.

04 This pressure is strongest in repetitive, rules-rich, system-connected workflows.

// STRATEGIC_TRANSFORMATION

SOLUTION: AGENTIC AI TURNS SAAS INTO A SYSTEM OF ACTION

> *The product shift is from prompt-response interfaces to workflow execution layers*

ORGANIZATIONS THAT HAVE DEPLOYED AI AGENTS

17%

ORGANIZATIONS EXPECTING DEPLOYMENT WITHIN 2 YEARS

>60%

STRATEGIC_EXECUTION_MATRIX

01 Agents can reason across tasks, retrieve context, call APIs, and execute multi-step workflows.

02 Enterprise value comes from combining models with workflow permissions, business logic, and data context.

03 The winning product pattern is not standalone chat; it is embedded, permission-aware workflow automation.

04 This creates a new control layer above applications and across SaaS ecosystems.

// STRATEGIC_TRANSFORMATION

MARKET IMPACT: EMBEDDED AGENTS ARE BECOMING A DEFAULT SAAS CAPABILITY

> *Enterprise applications are absorbing agentic functionality fast*

ENTERPRISE APP PENETRATION 2025

<5%

ENTERPRISE APP PENETRATION 2026E

40%

APPROXIMATE INCREASE

8x

STRATEGIC_EXECUTION_MATRIX

01 Gartner expects 40% of enterprise applications to include task-specific AI agents by end-2026.

02 That compares with less than 5% in 2025.

03 This implies an approximate 8x rise in agent penetration inside enterprise apps in about a year.

04 For buyers, the question shifts from 'Should we use agents?' to 'Where should we build vs buy?'

// STRATEGIC_TRANSFORMATION

BUSINESS MODEL SHIFT: MONETIZATION IS MOVING FROM SEATS TO WORK AND OUTCOMES

> *Agentic SaaS changes how value is priced and measured*

LEGACY PRICING BASIS

Seats

EMERGING PRICING BASIS

Actions / outcomes

STRATEGIC_EXECUTION_MATRIX

01 Autonomous workflows decouple software value from named-user seats.

02 Vendors are experimenting with action-based, work-unit, and outcome-based pricing.

03 Salesforce has promoted Agentic Work Units as an output-focused metric.

04 Gartner's Outcome as Agentic Solution concept signals a broader shift from software access to business results.

// STRATEGIC_TRANSFORMATION

CONSTRAINT: GOVERNANCE, SECURITY, AND COST CONTROL ARE NOW THE REAL ADOPTION GATES

> *The hardest enterprise problem is no longer model access; it's trusted execution at scale*

SECURITY / PRIVACY / COMPLIANCE CITED AS BARRIER

52%

MANAGING AGENTS AT SCALE CITED AS BARRIER

51%

STRATEGIC_EXECUTION_MATRIX

01 Governance, security, and FinOps are becoming dedicated categories around agentic AI.

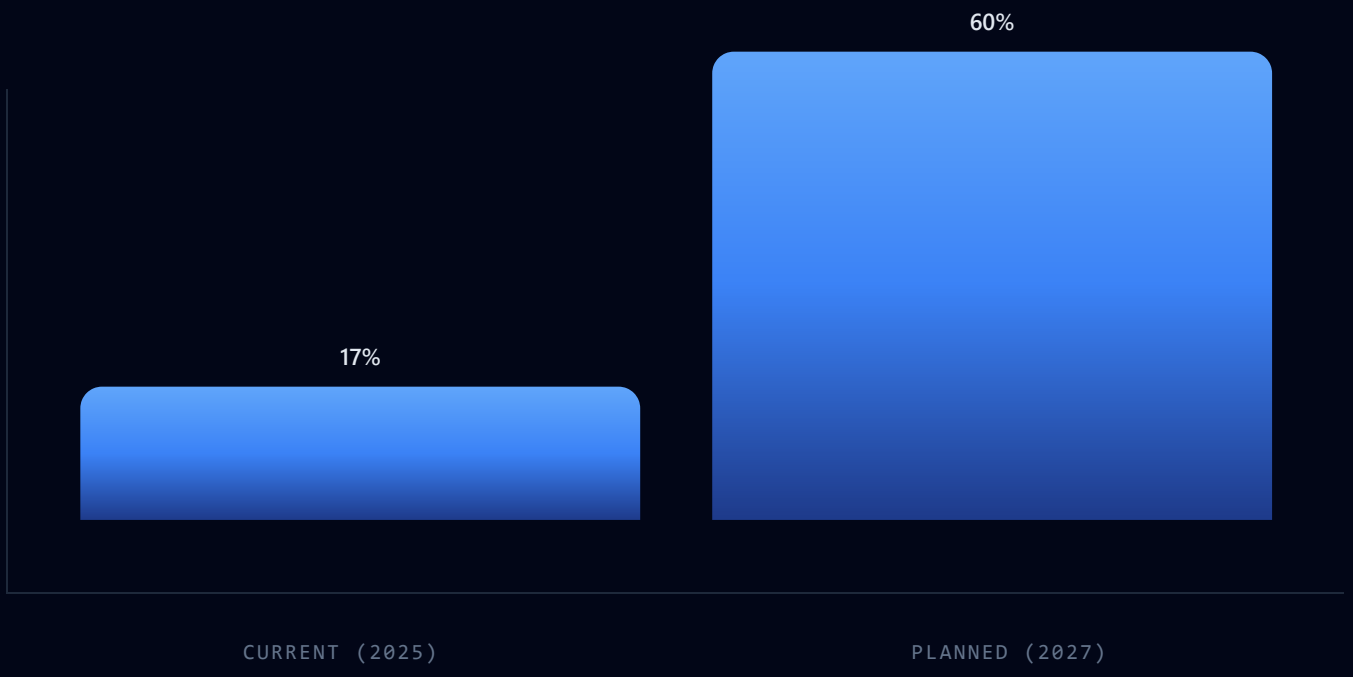
02 Enterprises worry about permissions, data exposure, auditability, and unmanaged cost.

03 Technical orchestration across multiple systems remains difficult even when model quality is strong.

04 The strongest SaaS platforms will win on trust and control, not just intelligence.

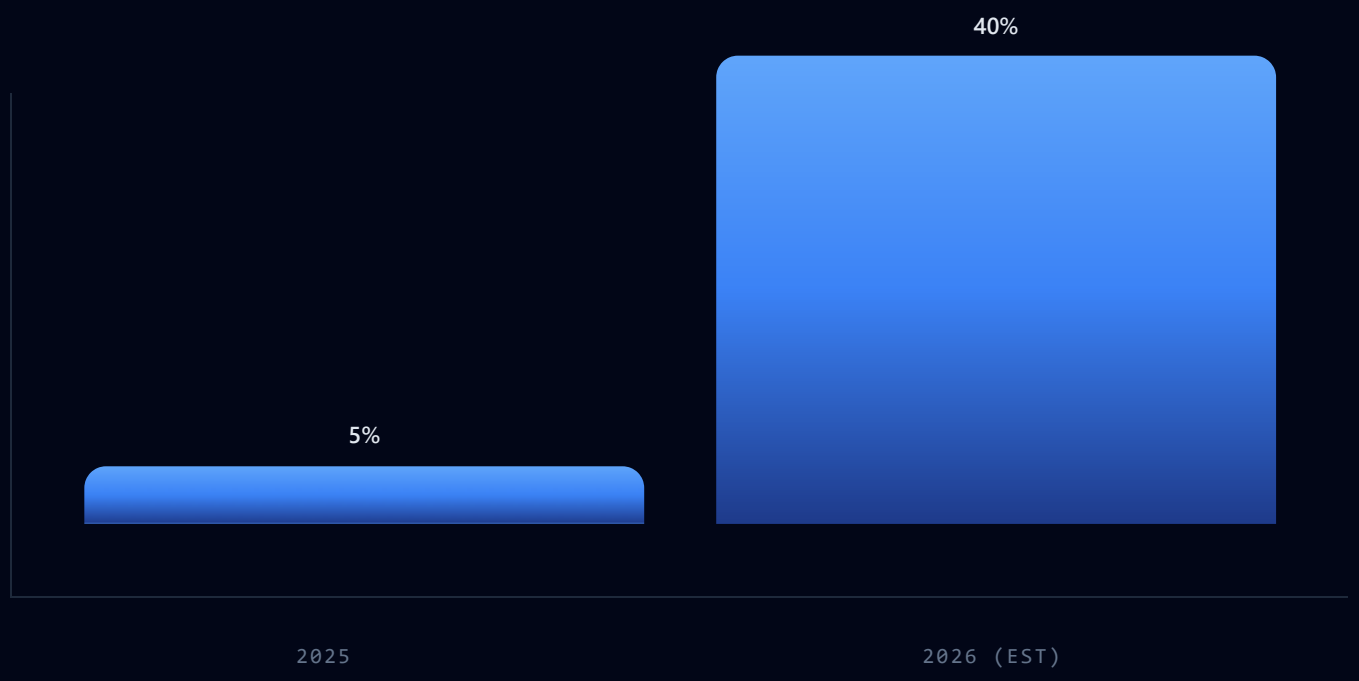
PROOF #1: ENTERPRISE ADOPTION IS EARLY, BUT THE PIPELINE IS LARGE

Intent to deploy far outpaces current production deployment



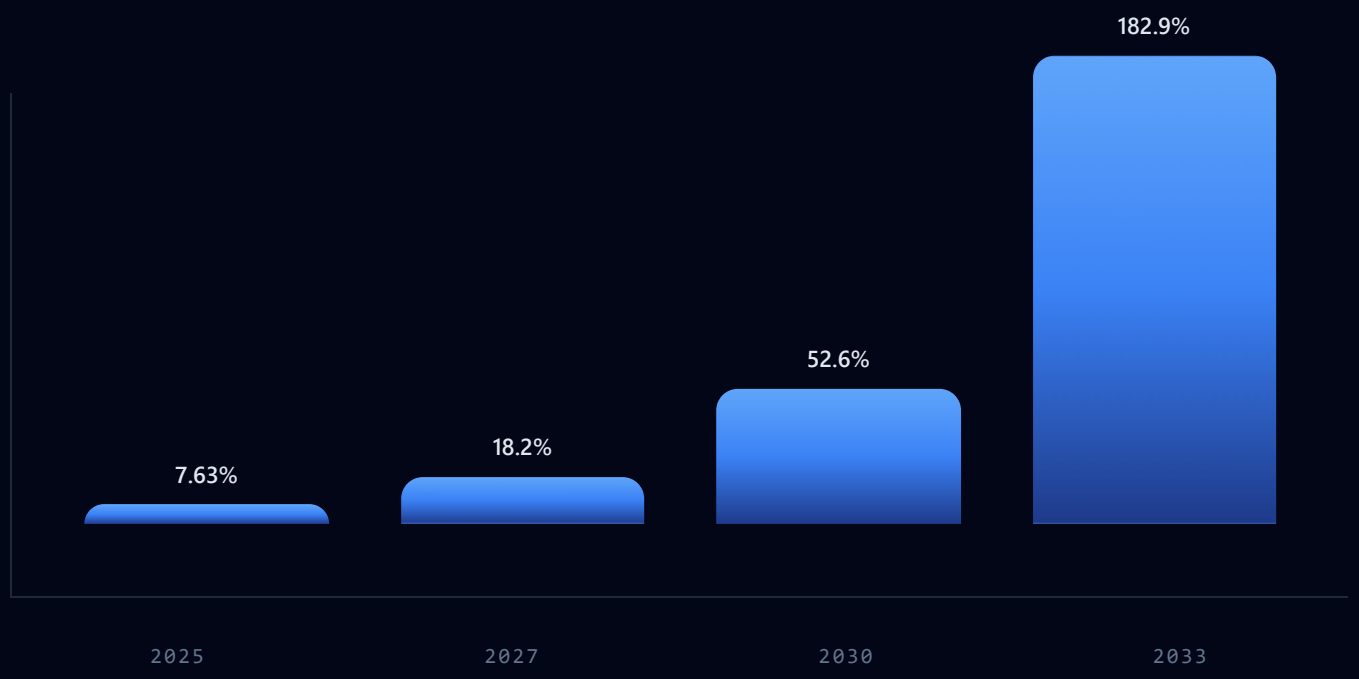
PROOF #2: AGENT PENETRATION INSIDE ENTERPRISE APPS IS RISING SHARPLY

Embedded agents are moving from edge feature to standard capability



PROOF #3: AI AGENTS ARE BECOMING A HYPERGROWTH SOFTWARE CATEGORY

Forecasts vary, but all point to steep expansion



"As companies move toward becoming agentic enterprises, true transformation happens when data and AI move in lockstep."

MICHAEL ANDREW

CHIEF DATA OFFICER // SALESFORCE

BOTTOM LINE: THE NEXT SAAS WINNERS WILL EXECUTE WORK, NOT JUST ENABLE IT

- Agentic AI is becoming embedded across enterprise applications faster than most SaaS shifts.
- The market is early in deployment but strong in intent and budget momentum.
- Pricing is evolving from seats toward tasks, actions, and outcomes.
- Governance, security, and observability will determine which vendors scale.
- SaaS leaders should embed agents in workflows, monetize outcomes, and build trust controls now.

ENTERPRISE APPS WITH AGENTS BY END-2026

40%

ORGANIZATIONS EXPECTING DEPLOYMENT IN 2 YEARS

>60%

AI AGENTS MARKET BY 2033

$182.97B

STRATEGIC SUMMARY COMPLETE